

THE UNIVERSAL HOUSE OF JUSTICE

1991-10-30

1 copy of a letter dated 28 october 1991 which we have written at its instruc-
2 tion to a believer who is an academic and who requested that consideration be given
to changing the bahá'í administrative policy requiring prepublica-
3 tion review of manuscripts authored by bahá'ís.

4 119-1 The concern expressed
5 is that this policy contradicts values of free inquiry as perceived in academic
6 circles and that submission to it could undermine scholarly credibility. As
7 you will see from the enclosure, the house of justice does not agree with
8 this perception of bahá'í review, but it sympathizes with the difficulties
9 faced by bahá'í academics in upholding and defending bahá'í policy. your
10 attention is called particularly to the penultimate paragraph of the letter which
mentions an approach intended to ease these difficulties and which can readily be
accommodated by the current regulations on bahá'í review.

11 The scholar who has authored a manuscript on a bahá'í subject may rec-
12 ommend to the National Spiritual Assembly one or more individuals for in-clusion
among the reviewers selected by the Assembly. if for some particular
13 reason the Assembly finds his nominees unacceptable, it may ask the author
14 to submit other names for its consideration. while the National Assem-
15 bly must retain control of the reviewing process and operate its reviewing
16 119-1. See no. 118, pp. 240-43.119.1

119.2118 9

120 m e S a g e S f r o m T h e u n i v e r S a l h o u S e o f j u S T i c e
121 2mechanism as it sees fit, it must at the same time exercise a flexibility which
122 will allow it to accommodate such a procedure. As in any other instance of
123 review, the Assembly should exercise independent judgment as to the merits
124 of the recommendations it receives from its appointed reviewers.
125 with loving bahá'í greetings,

Department of the secretariat

126 120

The Need for an Increase in Contributions to the Fund

[signed: The Universal House of Justice]